Fresh lime juice, cilantro, and dried poblano chiles—not to mention the corn tortillas—give a Mexican flavor to this spicy tomato soup.

sopa de tortilla

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 50 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
AT THE END OF STEP 2

5 tbsp sunflower oil
½ onion, finely chopped
2 large garlic cloves, finely chopped
1lb (450g) tomatoes, peeled
1.5 quarts (1.5 liters) chicken stock or vegetable stock
1 or 2 dried poblano chiles, seeded
2 soft corn tortillas, cut into strips
3 tbsp chopped fresh cilantro
2 tbsp fresh lime juice
salt and freshly ground black pepper
3oz (85g) Gruyère cheese, grated
2 limes, cut into wedges, to serve

1 Heat 1 tbsp of the oil in a large saucepan over medium heat. Add the onion and cook, stirring, for 5 minutes, until softened. Add the garlic and stir for 30 seconds. Using a blender, process with the tomatoes until smooth.

2 Add the tomato-onion purée to the pan and simmer for 8–10 minutes, stirring constantly. Stir in the stock and bring to a boil. Reduce the heat, partially cover the pan, and simmer for 15 minutes or until thickened.

3 Place a nonstick frying pan over medium heat. Add the chiles and press them flat against the pan with a spatula until they blister, then repeat on the other side. Remove from the pan, cut into small pieces, and set aside.

4 Heat the remaining oil in the frying pan until sizzling hot. Add the tortilla strips in batches and fry until just crisp. Remove with a slotted spoon and drain on paper towels.

5 When ready to serve, add the chiles to the soup, bring to a boil, and simmer for 3 minutes, or until the chiles are soft. Stir in the cilantro and lime juice and season with salt and pepper. Divide the toasted tortilla strips between 4 soup bowls. Ladle in the soup and top with a sprinkling of cheese. Serve with wedges of lime.